

Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant

Wells Fargo Clearing Services, LLC

Case Number: 25-01618

vs.

Respondent

Akili M. Johnson

Hearing Site: Dallas, Texas

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Member vs. Associated Person

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

For Claimant Wells Fargo Clearing Services, LLC (“Claimant”): Keith J. Barnett, Esq., Troutman Pepper Locke LLP, Atlanta, Georgia and Seth M. Erickson, Esq. and So Young (Anna) Lee, Esq., Troutman Pepper Locke LLP, Chicago, Illinois.

Respondent Akili M. Johnson (“Respondent”) did not appear.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: August 6, 2025.

Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: August 6, 2025.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant asserted a cause of action for breach of promissory note. Claimant asserted that Respondent took a loan on favorable terms from Claimant and is now refusing to repay the loan, which was evidenced by an unambiguous Promissory Note signed by Respondent (“Note”).

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant requested an award of the principal balance due and owing under the Note in the amount of \$771,321.48 and interest accrued during the term of the Note at the rate of 1.71% per annum; interest at rate of 4.71% per annum on the balance due and owing under the Note from the date of default (December 2, 2024) to the date of payment; the costs of collection and of this proceeding including attorneys’ fees as agreed to under the terms of the Note; and any and all further relief that the Arbitrator deems just and proper.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrator acknowledges having read the pleadings and other materials filed by Claimant.

Respondent did not file a Statement of Answer. Accordingly, this matter proceeded pursuant Rule 13807(e)(1) of the Code of Arbitration Procedure ("Code").

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent was served with the Claim Notification letter dated August 11, 2025, by regular mail, and the Overdue Notice (including the Statement of Claim) dated October 1, 2025, by regular mail and FedEx, as evidenced by the FedEx tracking information available online. The Arbitrator also determined that Respondent was served with the Notification of Arbitration dated October 22, 2025, by regular mail and FedEx, as evidenced by the FedEx tracking information available online.

The Claim Notification letter notified Respondent that FINRA rules require parties to use the online DR Portal on a mandatory basis (except pro se investors) and that failure to register for the DR Portal will prevent the submission of pleadings, selection of arbitrators, and receipt of notification relating to case information and deadlines. Respondent failed to register for the DR Portal.

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent is, therefore, bound by the Arbitrator's ruling and determination.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the Arbitrator has decided and determined in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$771,321.48.
2. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant interest on the above-stated sum at the rate of 4.71% from December 2, 2024, through and including the date this Award is paid in full.
3. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$1,695.00 to reimburse Claimant for the non-refundable portion of the filing fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
4. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$300.00 to reimburse Claimant for the Paper Decision Fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
5. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein, including any requests for attorneys' fees, are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code, Claimant has paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$3,420.00 Member Surcharge and \$6,800.00 Member Process Fee previously invoiced.

Claimant has also paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$1,695.00 non-refundable portion of the filing fee and the \$300.00 Paper Decision Fee.

ARBITRATOR

Andrea U. Calve

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Sole Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Arbitrator's Signature

Andrea U. Calve

Andrea U. Calve
Sole Public Arbitrator

11/12/2025

Signature Date

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November 12, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)